kets, we will skip them in this FastTrack. The CPU has pins coming out of its body at the bottom or there are pins in the CPU socket. The former is called PGA(Pin Grid Array) and the latter is called LGA(Land Grid Array). Intel uses LGA while AMD has PGA. The two are not compatible with each other. It is common sense that if the number of pins and their layout on the CPU differs from that on the motherboard, they are not going to fit together.

Very similarly, every motherboard is designed to house a particular type of memory module. This is determined by both its DDR type and the clock frequency. It is not possible to shove a different kind of DDR memory into a motherboard than what it was designed for. It is so because of how RAM modules are designed physically. Have a look at the picture above and you can understand why one module type won't fit in a motherboard with a slot for another type.

Providing connection points to other components: Graphics Cards mostly go into the PCIe slots with x16 width. These slots are placed parallel to each other and are perpendicular to the edge on which all built-in I/O ports (like USB, Ethernet, Display port, Audio ports etc.) are placed. These slots must be marked on the board.

The motherboard also provides the ports for connecting SATA, PATA devices, connectors to front-panel USB and audio jacks as well as the Power/Reset buttons. You should be able to see them marked on the motherboard. You might get confused with smaller names and numbers labelled on the motherboard. If you have a doubt, take a picture ready and head to the digit forum to get all your answers.

Which motherboard is right for me?

You need to select a motherboard keeping other components' compatibility in mind, especially CPU and RAM modules

Basic Rig

Asus A68HM-K works well with AMD A8-7600 and comes with 2 DIMMs supporting up to 32 GB, three SATA ports, support for USB 3.0 and has built-in support for DVI and D-SUB.

Entry Level Gaming

Gigabyte GA-B250M-DS3H is a good motherboard with support for up to 64 GB DDR4 RAM over 4 slots (almost all motherboards support